25 POSTS · 24 ACCOUNTS · 9.6M IMPRESSIONS

THE EXECUTIVE SWIPE FILE

Twenty-five of the best performing posts we published for B2B founders and executives this year, each with its real numbers and the pattern underneath. Two of them bought enormous reach and returned nothing, and they're in here too.

WHAT THIS IS

I'm a partner at RallyUp, where we write LinkedIn for B2B founders and executives. In 2026 the accounts we run did **9.6 million impressions across 24 accounts at 16 companies**, from more than 750 posts.

This document is the part of that work worth stealing. Every post below is real and every number comes from the account's own analytics. I've anonymised the accounts, because the posts belong to the people who published them.

What I've kept is the shape of each post, why it worked, and the part you can lift without borrowing anyone's words.

> **The honest promise.** These patterns move numbers on accounts that already have something to say. They won't hand you a point of view or rescue a post about nothing. Any guide that credits a format for a post's success is selling you the easy half.

READ IT IN THREE BUCKETS

We file every post before it's written: top of funnel, middle or bottom. The mix runs roughly 70 / 20 / 10, and each bucket gets graded on a different number. That's the only rule here that matters.

BUCKET	BUILT FOR	GRADED ON
Top	Reach: a personal story, a take on this week's news, humour	`Impressions`
Middle	Trust: the breakdown, the analysis, what you learned doing it at volume	`Saves, profile views`
Bottom	Action: the role, the launch, the raise, the offer	`Comments, applications, calls`

Grade all three on impressions and you'll kill the two that are working.

THE FINDING THAT SHOULD REFRAME THE REST

Two posts went out on the same account, one day apart.

	A HIRING POST	A VIRAL PERSONAL POST
Impressions	15,376	178,179
Profile views	230	213
New followers	24	13
Saves	37	11
Comments	49	22
Sends	14	2
Engagement rate	1.33%	0.089%

The second post reached **11.6 times** as many people and still lost on every measure that matters, on the same account, in the same week, from the same writer.

If you take one thing from this document, take that. Reach is the cheapest number on the page to count, which is exactly why everyone counts it.

1. INTRO POSTS

Most executives treat the intro as a warm-up, so almost nobody plans it, and it's usually the highest converting post they'll ever publish.

01 · PARTNER AT AN EARLY-STAGE VENTURE FUND, 11 YEARS AT THE FIRM, FIRST POST EVER TOF

"Hello LinkedIn, I'm here, and here's why I'm finally showing up"

50,137	1,899	218	784	118	45
IMPRESSIONS	PROFILE VIEWS	FOLLOWERS	REACTIONS	COMMENTS	SAVES

The angle. A dated timeline of one career at one firm in place of a bio, plus the admission that posting felt unnatural and five specific things he'd write about next.

> **Why it performed.** 37.9 profile views per thousand impressions, roughly ten times what his later posts do. New accounts get an outsized first push from the algorithm, and an introduction is the one post where talking about yourself is the whole point instead of a tax the reader pays.

> **Steal this.** End the intro with the list of what you'll write about. A follow becomes a subscription, and you've committed in public to a beat, which is what actually keeps people posting in month three.

02 · THE SAME ACCOUNT, TWO WEEKS LATER MOF

The follow-up that got more reach and less of everything else

69,980	994	159	159
IMPRESSIONS	PROFILE VIEWS	FOLLOWERS	SAVES

The angle. He asks all 128 portfolio companies for a quarterly update, so he published the one he writes about himself: deal funnel, time allocation, which founders he was genuinely useful to, and what he missed.

Why it performed. 39.6% more reach than the intro and about half the profile views, so the two posts did different jobs. Look at the saves, though: 159, or 2.27 per thousand, the highest rate in this file. People save what they intend to copy.

Steal this. Publish the internal artifact itself, uncomfortable section included, instead of a description of your process. His longest section is "what I missed."

2. LAUNCH POSTS

Launches get our highest engagement rates on every account we run, because they give people something to react to besides an opinion.

03 · HEALTHTECH STARTUP, PRODUCT LAUNCH ALONGSIDE A FUNDING ROUND, VIDEO

The one that bought 137 hours of attention and 15 clicks

181,619	64,122	137.2	28	15
IMPRESSIONS	VIDEO VIEWS	HOURS WATCHED	FOLLOWERS	LINK CLICKS

The angle. A model nobody had seen before, explained on video, with the raise and the investor names carried in the same post instead of split across two.

Why it performed. 61,963 separate people watched some of it and fifteen clicked. Video does that, because someone watching isn't in a clicking frame of mind. Engagement came in at 0.06%, the lowest rate in this file, on its biggest post.

Steal this. Use video when the launch asks for belief (a category, a vision, why you bothered at all). Use text when it asks someone to do something this week, and grade each one on the right number.

04 · AI MENTORING MARKETPLACE, WAITLIST LAUNCH, TEXT AND IMAGE

Two funnels in one post

38,291	554	343	36
IMPRESSIONS	LINK CLICKS	COMMENTS	FOLLOWERS

The angle. The post asked for two actions on purpose: comment below, and fill in the form on the site.

Why it performed. It got a fifth of the video's reach and 37 times the clicks. A comment is free, public and takes four seconds, so people leave one, and each comment pushes the post to more people who then comment too. Most of the qualified signups never touched the link.

Steal this. Put a comment gate and a link in the same post. Most of the field dropped comment gates on taste, and the data disagrees with the taste.

05 · AGENT INFRASTRUCTURE FOUNDER, PARTNERSHIP ANNOUNCEMENT

Launching on somebody else's momentum

17,759	100	20	12
IMPRESSIONS	PROFILE VIEWS	SAVES	FOLLOWERS

The angle. A partner company had just raised a $24M Series A. He skipped the logo-swap announcement and explained what the two products do together in a line a reader could repeat: if they're the chip, we're the computer.

Why it performed. 20 saves on 17,759 impressions is a strong rate for an announcement, since those usually save at close to zero. The analogy did that; people save a sentence they can reuse in their own meetings.

Steal this. Announce partnerships on the other company's news cycle and give the relationship a one-line metaphor. "We integrate with X" reads like a press release, whereas "If they're the chip, we're the computer" is something people repeat for you.

3. HIRING POSTS

We've hired our entire team through these. They reach fewer people than any other post type in this file and beat almost everything on the measures that aren't reach.

06 · OUR OWN FOUNDER, HIRING A FOUNDING GTM ENGINEER

The post that beat a viral post by every measure except views

15,376	230	37	49	24	14
IMPRESSIONS	PROFILE VIEWS	SAVES	COMMENTS	FOLLOWERS	SENDS

The angle. It opened on frustration instead of a job title. Then came four bullets on who'd be right, an honest line that the role isn't for everyone, and an application mechanic with a filter built in: comment with something you've built, and he'd only reply to comments with a personal video attached.

Why it performed. 37 saves and 14 sends. A send means someone forwarded the role to a specific person, the most valuable action on LinkedIn and the one nobody optimises for, and nothing gets forwarded like a good job.

Steal this. Put the filter in the ask so the screening call doesn't have to do it. Asking for a video cost him nothing and cut 90% of applicants before anyone spent time on them. He said so publicly afterwards, and that became the next post.

07 · THE FOLLOW-UP, SIX DAYS LATER

Reporting on your own hiring post

22,908	183	32	9
IMPRESSIONS	PROFILE VIEWS	COMMENTS	SAVES

The angle. What the applications actually looked like. Some people applying for an outreach job spelled his name wrong, and fewer than one in ten sent the video the post asked for. He turned it into encouragement for job seekers instead of a complaint.

Why it performed. It got more reach than the hiring post itself. A hiring post is an event, and events have a second day, yet most people publish the role and go quiet until it's filled.

Steal this. Every launch, raise and role has a follow-up post in it, built from what happened next. You already have the material and collecting it costs nothing.

08 · PHARMA MARKETPLACE, A SENIOR HIRE ANNOUNCEMENT

The hire as a signal about the company

1,580	53	10	4.1%
IMPRESSIONS	REACTIONS	COMMENTS	ENGAGEMENT

The angle. He skipped "delighted to welcome" and opened with why the role exists and what breaks without it. Then came her actual record, with named companies, and a line about what he'd decided in the first sixty seconds of the interview.

> **Why it performed.** 4.1% engagement, among the highest rates in this file, on one of the smallest audiences. On the measure that shows whether people cared, a specific, warm post to a small audience beats a big generic one.

> **Steal this.** Write the hire announcement as an argument about where the company is going, with the person as the evidence. "We're expanding fast across two regulated markets, and here's who makes sure implementation never breaks" tells a buyer more than a quarterly update does.

4. THE MIDDLE OF THE FUNNEL

This is where trust gets built, so these posts get graded on saves and profile views and never on reach.

09 · VENTURE PARTNER, ANSWERING A CRITIC IN PUBLIC

Taking the strongest argument against you seriously

45,252	510	37	30
IMPRESSIONS	PROFILE VIEWS	FOLLOWERS	SAVES

The angle. A founder had challenged him in the comments of an earlier post: what use is an investor who has never founded anything? He conceded the premise up top, then answered with nine months of counts from one portfolio company: 59 intro meetings, 13 candidates approached, 2 hires, 1 follow-on cheque.

> **Why it performed.** 11.3 profile views per thousand, about triple his baseline. Handle a public disagreement generously and people want to see who you are.

> **Steal this.** When somebody challenges you in a comment, answer in a post instead. Name the challenge accurately and reply with counts rather than conviction.

10 · VENTURE PARTNER, A CONTRARIAN POSITION ON HOW HIS OWN INDUSTRY WORKS

Disagreeing with a named peer, respectfully

34,434	43	52	9
IMPRESSIONS	SAVES	FOLLOWERS	SHARES

The angle. He credited another investor's framework by name and called it the clearest explanation of the model he'd seen. Then he explained why he thinks it's wrong for early stage and gave the four screening questions he uses instead.

Why it performed. 9 shares is high for a text post. Crediting the person you're disagreeing with makes the post easy to forward; a fight is something people avoid passing on.

Steal this. Name who you're disagreeing with and steelman them first. The post gets better, and the person you named often turns up in the comments, which doubles the reach.

11 · OUR OWN FOUNDER, THE THREE-BUCKET MODEL

Publishing your own numbers, including a post that flopped

4,453	9	17
IMPRESSIONS	SAVES	PROFILE VIEWS

The angle. He compared two of his own posts, one with 12 times the reach of the other, showed that the smaller one won on followers, comments and saves, and then gave the 70 / 20 / 10 split.

Why it performed. Low reach and 2 saves per thousand: a middle of funnel post doing its job, with a small number of the right people filing it away.

Steal this. Publish the post that underperformed, numbers included, next to the one that worked. Almost nobody does, and that's why it lands.

12 · AGENT INFRASTRUCTURE FOUNDER, A FRAMEWORK WITH LEVELS

Naming the thing everyone's stuck on

471	3.6%
IMPRESSIONS	ENGAGEMENT

The angle. Five levels of agent autonomy, with level one described as "it worked once, it cost $20 in tokens, and nobody knows if it'll ever run again." Then the line that carries the post: the market demos at level one and sells at level four.

Why it performed. It barely reached anyone and still ran at 3.6% engagement. I included it because the reach is bad: a framework post is a bet that the right 400 people see it.

Steal this. Give the levels unflattering names and put your own category somewhere in the middle. A maturity model with you already at the top reads as marketing.

13 · AGENT INFRASTRUCTURE FOUNDER, TAKING A PUBLIC POSITION ON AN INDUSTRY LETTER

Attaching yourself to a bigger story, with a reason

5,715	113	45
IMPRESSIONS	REACTIONS	PROFILE VIEWS

The angle. A very large company published a letter and his company signed it. He skipped announcing the signature and explained what open weights mean for a buyer: your data, your systems, your edge stay yours.

Why it performed. 113 reactions on 5,715 impressions is a 2% reaction rate. Newsjacking usually fails because the post adds nothing to the news, and this one translated the news into the reader's own risk.

Steal this. When you join a public position, publish the translation and drop the announcement. Say what it means for the person reading, in their language, about their money.

5. PERSONAL STORY, THE TOP OF THE FUNNEL

About 70% of what we publish sits here. It's graded on impressions and nothing else, which is the only reason it gets to be this personal.

14 · OUR OWN FOUNDER, THE DAY HE WAS LET GO

"48 minutes after getting fired, I posted about it"

18,864	184	7	76
IMPRESSIONS	PROFILE VIEWS	SAVES	REACTIONS

The angle. He lost the Slack, the inbox and every partnership he'd built, and the one asset that came with him was the audience on his personal account. That set up the argument: almost nothing you build inside a company is portable.

> **Why it performed.** 9.8 profile views per thousand. The story about loss resolves into an argument other people can use, where most end on a lesson about resilience.

> **Steal this.** Your worst professional day is often your best post, as long as it ends in an argument somebody else can use. Without that, it's a story about you.

15 · OUR OWN FOUNDER, TURNING DOWN THE BIGGER RAISE

"A Tier 1 VC told me my company could sell for $150 million, then told me to get out"

42,589	332	10	13
IMPRESSIONS	PROFILE VIEWS	FOLLOWERS	COMMENTS

The angle. The investor loved the business and passed anyway, because an excellent company wasn't a fund returner. Then the honest part: he was 27, newly married with a new baby, and not sure he wanted the moonshot. He admits he still gets a little green reading funding headlines.

> **Why it performed.** 7.8 profile views per thousand on a text post with no image, and the admission of envy is what earned them. Most founder posts about choosing sustainability over scale read like a decision made in peace long ago.

> **Steal this.** Leave the unresolved part in. "I'm not pretending this is set in stone" is the line that keeps it from reading as a humblebrag.

16 · FOUR-TIME FOUNDER, THE PITCH EVERYONE REJECTED

"VCs gave me a 0% chance"

3,018	42	80	7
IMPRESSIONS	PROFILE VIEWS	REACTIONS	SAVES

The angle. A marketplace with a cold-start problem, solved by three named drivers who recruited their colleagues one cab at a time until 3,000 were on the platform before launch. He then tied it to what he's building now.

Why it performed. 2.3 saves per thousand, unusual for a story post. Readers save the mechanic: three named people and a number make a tactic, while "we hustled" stays an anecdote.

Steal this. Give the origin story one operational detail a reader could copy, or you've written an autobiography.

17 · OUR OWN FOUNDER, SELLING WITH A BABY STRAPPED TO HIS CHEST

The imperfection as the strategy

2,931	41	30%
IMPRESSIONS	REACTIONS	REPLY RATE CLAIMED

The angle. He recorded one-minute cold videos for each prospect while walking his newborn, with spit-up on his shirt in seven of them, and closed 15 deals. His argument is that the mess proved a person made it.

Why it performed. Modest reach and a very high engagement rate. The post also carries its own disclaimer, saying plainly that he isn't telling you to put a baby in your sales pitch.

Steal this. If your tactic could be read badly, say so inside the post. The disclaimer earns you the right to tell the story.

18 · AGENT INFRASTRUCTURE FOUNDER, THE PIVOT THEY NEARLY DIDN'T MAKE

"We almost didn't launch"

3,678	29	80
IMPRESSIONS	PROFILE VIEWS	REACTIONS

The angle. Three founders from one industry spent months finding nothing worth building in it, until one of them finally said the sentence out loud. The reframe: not knowing the space is what let them see what was broken.

> **Why it performed.** 2.2% engagement. He names the fear precisely and addresses the ending to one specific person, the founder sitting in that room right now, arguing themselves out of it.

> **Steal this.** End the story by naming who it's for. "If you're the person currently doing X" turns a story into advice without a lecture.

19 · FOUR-TIME FOUNDER, AGAINST THE OVERWORK CULTURE

Taking the unpopular side of a live argument

4,477	11	5
IMPRESSIONS	COMMENTS	SAVES

The angle. He calls the 72-hour work week a disgrace, then concedes straight away that he works seven days a week himself and loves it. His position is about measuring output instead of hours, and working less never comes into it.

> **Why it performed.** The concession is why the comments are real. Attack only the other side and you get agreement, but admit you're closer to them than you'd like and you get an argument.

> **Steal this.** Find the part of the position you're attacking that you're guilty of, and put it in paragraph three.

20 · OUR OWN FOUNDER, THE EQUITY THAT NEVER VESTED

A number in the news, made personal

13,209	224	39
IMPRESSIONS	PROFILE VIEWS	REACTIONS

The angle. A company he'd worked at hit a $60 billion valuation. His equity would have made him a millionaire, except it never vested, because he left to move abroad. There's no regret in the post, only the arithmetic and what he chose instead.

> **Why it performed.** 17 profile views per thousand, one of the highest rates in this file, from a headline everyone saw attached to one person's actual consequence.

> **Steal this.** When a number from your past is in the news this week, you have a post. The news brings the reach and your consequence does the rest.

21 · FOUR-TIME FOUNDER, THE STUDENT TALK

An opening line that has nothing to do with the point

1,931	39	60
IMPRESSIONS	PROFILE VIEWS	REACTIONS

The angle. "25 years ago, I let my university scan my brain for $200. They promised to send me the results. I'm still waiting." Then four companies in four unrelated industries, and why staying in one lane limits you.

> **Why it performed.** 20 profile views per thousand on a small post. The opening buys the first three seconds with something genuinely odd that also happens to be true.

> **Steal this.** The hook doesn't need to be the argument; it needs to be true, strange and short. Most people write a hook that summarises the post, which is the one job a hook should never take on.

6. THE EXPENSIVE LESSONS

The first two posts here reached enormous numbers of people and returned almost nothing, which makes them the most useful pages in the file. The two after them show what small posts can do instead.

22 · MARKETPLACE CEO, A MOTIVATIONAL ONE-LINER OVER AN IMAGE

72,076 impressions and seven followers

72,076	7	22	331
IMPRESSIONS	FOLLOWERS	SAVES	REACTIONS

The angle. "The most successful people have a worse hit rate than you think." One sentence, one image and a sign-off.

> **Why it's here.** Three weeks earlier the same account published a launch post that did 38,291 impressions and filled a waitlist in a day. This one nearly doubled the reach and produced seven followers, because reach is only the cheapest number on the page to count.

> **Steal this.** Nothing, and that's the point. If you can't grade a post on anything except impressions, you already know what it'll return.

23 · OUR OWN FOUNDER, THE VIRAL ONE

178,179 impressions and 11 saves

178,179	213	13	11
IMPRESSIONS	PROFILE VIEWS	FOLLOWERS	SAVES

The angle. His father-in-law asked over dinner whether AI was about to replace his whole company. He took the question seriously and answered it properly, arguing that taste survives once words become a commodity.

> **Why it's here.** It's a good post, and it's the exact post the hiring post beat on followers, saves, comments, sends and profile views with 11.6 times less reach, one day apart. Judge them on the same number and you learn the wrong lesson from both.

> **Steal this.** Keep publishing these. File them as top of funnel before you write them, and never let the one that went big decide a quarter's strategy.

24 · OUR OWN FOUNDER, THE FOUR-SECOND POST

The joke that outperformed the essays on followers

6,547	9	17
IMPRESSIONS	FOLLOWERS	COMMENTS

The angle. Two lines, formatted as a LinkedIn celebration announcement, about eating dinner in a hut for a religious holiday.

Why it's here. Nine followers from four seconds of work, while the 42,589-impression founder essay in this file produced ten. On this platform effort and return don't move together, and pretending they do is how people burn out in month two.

Steal this. Keep three or four of these in the bank for weeks when the real post isn't ready. Cadence matters more than every post being substantial.

25 · OUR OWN FOUNDER, THE ONE THAT ASKS FOR THE BUSINESS

What a bottom of funnel post is actually allowed to do

4,286	28	7
IMPRESSIONS	COMMENTS	SAVES

The angle. The full arc: a cold inbound message from an investor, a wire eight days later, seven months building something nobody wanted on almost no revenue, the pivot, and then the numbers. The offer and a guarantee come only after all of that.

Why it's here. 4,286 impressions, the lowest reach of any post on that account that month, on the one post that asks for money. You get 10% of your posting slots for this, and you pay for them with the other 90%.

Steal this. Earn the ask with the failure. Seven months of almost no revenue is what makes the guarantee believable.

WHAT THIS CAN'T DO FOR YOU

The honest part, because the rest isn't believable without it.

25 posts from 24 accounts make a sample, nothing more. They're B2B, founder and executive led, almost all on LinkedIn, mostly in tech, healthcare and finance. If you sell to consumers, treat everything here as a hypothesis.

The patterns won't hand you a point of view. Every post in this file came from someone with something specific to say, usually something they'd earned the right to say. Format is the cheap half.

These are reach and engagement numbers, with no attribution. I can show you 230 profile views and 37 saves, but I can't draw a clean line from a save to a signed contract. LinkedIn doesn't give that data to anyone, and people who claim it are usually counting something else.

Account size changes everything. A 471-impression post on a small account can't be compared with a 178,179-impression post on a large one, and I haven't normalised for size. Read the rates and ignore the totals.

THE ONE PAGE VERSION

1. File every post as top, middle or bottom of funnel before you write it. Roughly 70 / 20 / 10.
2. Grade each bucket on a different number: impressions, then saves and profile views, then comments and applications.
3. Write the intro post properly. It's the highest converting post you'll publish, and you only get one.
4. End the intro with what you'll write about next.
5. Video for belief, text for action. A video launch can buy 137 hours of attention and almost no clicks.
6. Put two actions in a launch, a comment and a link, because they're separate funnels.
7. Publish the internal artifact, with the uncomfortable section left in.
8. Answer critics in a post, with counts, and leave the comment thread alone.
9. Put the filter inside the hiring ask by asking for something that takes effort.
10. Every launch, raise and role has a follow-up post made of what happened.
11. Keep four-second posts in the bank for the weeks the real one isn't ready.
12. Never let the post that went viral decide next quarter.

Francisco Gost writes The Draft, a weekly letter on how top 1% startups crush organic marketing, at franciscogost.com

Partner at RallyUp. 21.3M+ impressions generated for B2B founders and execs.